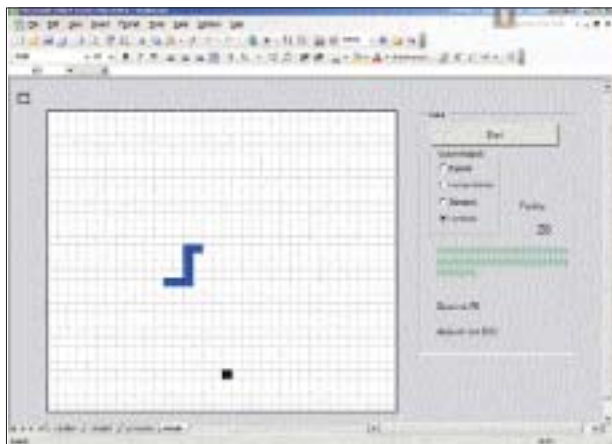




Waiter! There's a Snake in my Excel!

[Space bar] to fire at other cars, [O] to drop oil and [H] to turn on the headlights.

For those of you still using Excel 97, there's an egg for you too. Open a new workbook in Excel and press [F5] to bring up the 'Go to' dialogue box. Type 'X97:L97' and click OK. Press [Tab], then [Ctrl] + [Shift] and click on the 'Chart Wizard' icon. You will be taken to a game that's akin to Microsoft's *Flight Simulator*. Left-clicking will accelerate and right-clicking will slow you down. The developer's credits appear

as you fly to the side of a grey stone pyramid on the purple landscape. Hold down [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Esc] to exit. If this doesn't work, go to **Tools > Options**, click Transition, uncheck 'Transition navigation Keys' and click OK. Try again and the egg should pop up.

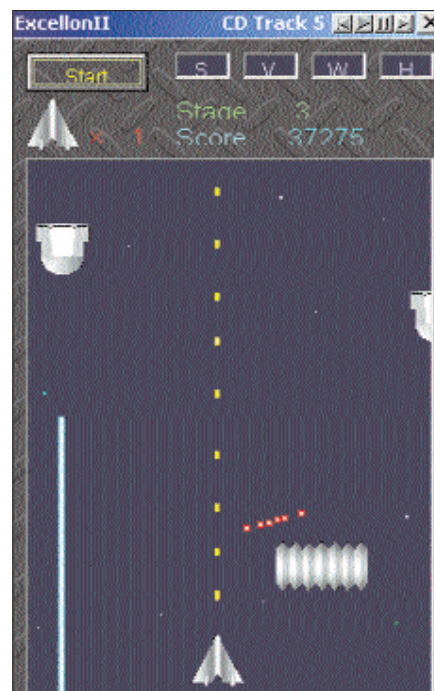
Apart from these game-like Easter eggs, you can also view the standard developers' credits. In Excel 2000, open a new workbook, press [F5],

enter 'X2000:L2000' in the dialogue box and press [Enter]. Press [Tab] once to highlight the cell M2000. Press [Ctrl] + [Shift] and click 'Chart Wizard' on the toolbar to see a scrolling list of developers. Press any key to exit.

Visit www.eeggs.com and www.eggcentral.com for a detailed list of Easter eggs for software, games and movies.

More oddities in Excel

Apart from the games and Easter eggs, here are a few more funny things about Excel—one of them being an interesting bug that identifies the year 1900 as a leap year. This bug has been carried over even to its latest version, Excel 2003. Hence, if you enter '=date(1900, 2, 29)' in a cell, it accepts it without error. Consequently, the dates prior to 1st March 1900 are also wrongly calculated. The bug has been explained as a necessity for compatibility. According to Microsoft, Lotus 1-2-3 counted the year 1900 as a leap year to simplify the handling of leap years, and Excel too assumes



Believe it or not—this was made in Excel!

the same to ensure compatibility.

Also, a little known fact is that your name gets embedded in an Excel file whenever you open and close it—even without saving. Get an Excel file that has already been used on another machine, and open it using Notepad. Press [F3] to activate the Find dialogue, and enter the name of the person who last accessed the file. You will find the name embedded in the file. Now, close Notepad and open the file in Excel and close it, without saving it. Open the file with Notepad again, and you will see that your name is now embedded. Note that this doesn't happen with files marked as 'Read Only', and the name embedded is the person that Microsoft Office is licensed to.

Have you ever tried to rename a worksheet to 'History'? Try doing that, and Excel will pop up a warning saying 'History is a reserved name'. This is because Excel creates a worksheet named History when you select 'List changes on a new sheet' in the 'Highlight Changes' dialogue box.

Feel like coming up with a little Excel delight of your own? Well, to start with, visit http://xcelfiles.homestead.com/VBA_01.html, which has many helpful VBA scripts that help you understand the power of VBA. Those of you that are dying to try out all the games we mentioned in this article, go ahead and indulge in Excel-lent gaming madness!

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